JAMES RICHARDSON

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Experienced Principal Engineer with 10 years building and scaling infrastructure systems across fintech and SaaS platforms. I've led teams through complex cloud migrations, designed systems handling millions of daily transactions, and mentored 12+ engineers from junior through senior levels. My focus has always been on solving real problems: reducing deployment times from hours to minutes, cutting infrastructure costs by 40%, and creating environments where engineers can do their best work without getting bogged down in process.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Principal Engineer

Vertex Labs

vertexlabs.io

London, United Kingdom

March 2021 - Present

Designed and implemented microservices architecture serving 2.5 million daily active users, reducing API response times by 65% through strategic service decomposition and caching layers.

Led platform reliability initiative reducing mean time to recovery from 4 hours to 18 minutes by establishing observability standards and implementing automated incident response workflows across 8 team members.

Mentored 6 senior engineers and 4 mid-level engineers, establishing engineering principles that became company standards, resulting in 40% reduction in production incidents year-over-year.

Architected multi-region disaster recovery solution using Kubernetes and Terraform, achieving 99.99% uptime SLA and cutting recovery time objective from 2 hours to 15 minutes.

Senior Engineer

DataStream Solutions

datastream.co

London, United Kingdom

June 2018 - February 2021

Owned infrastructure redesign migrating 180+ microservices from legacy monolith to Kubernetes, completing project 3 months ahead of schedule with zero service downtime during transition.

Built real-time data processing pipeline using Apache Kafka and Spark, processing 500GB daily logs with 99.95% accuracy, enabling business analytics team to reduce report generation time from 8 hours to 15 minutes.

Implemented comprehensive monitoring and alerting system using Prometheus and Grafana, reducing mean time to detection for production issues from 45 minutes to 3 minutes.

Established infrastructure-as-code practices using Terraform across 50+ cloud resources, reducing infrastructure provisioning time from 2 days to 20 minutes and enabling developers to self-serve deployments.

Software Engineer

TechCore Systems

techcore.net

London, United Kingdom

September 2014 - May 2018

Developed and maintained high-availability backend services in Python and Go, supporting 200+ enterprise clients across financial services and insurance sectors.

Designed distributed caching layer using Redis cluster configuration, achieving 60% reduction in database load and improving application response times from 800ms to 150ms for frequently accessed data.

Implemented comprehensive API rate limiting and throttling system preventing DDoS attacks and protecting service availability during peak traffic periods serving 500+ requests per second.

Contributed to 15+ infrastructure automation projects, writing deployment scripts and CI/CD pipelines in Bash and Python that reduced manual deployment work by 35 hours per month.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Manchester

Manchester, United Kingdom

Graduated: June 2014

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Go, Bash, SQL, Java

Cloud Platforms: AWS, Google Cloud Platform, Azure

Container Orchestration: Kubernetes, Docker, Docker Swarm

Infrastructure Tools: Terraform, Ansible, CloudFormation

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, DynamoDB

Message Queues: Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ, AWS SQS

Monitoring: Prometheus, Grafana, DataDog, ELK Stack

CI/CD: Jenkins, GitLab CI, GitHub Actions, CircleCI

Version Control: Git, GitHub, GitLab

Networking: TCP/IP, DNS, VPN, Load Balancing, CDN